

OREGON CITY COURIER

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TESTING IMMIGRANTS

The classification of immigrants by means of the Burnett Immigration bill, which provides a literacy test for certain classes of immigrants into the United States, does not meet with as much favor from the press at the seat of national government as it does from the government itself. The Washington Times sees in the Burnett bill only a restriction upon immigration for the benefit of those already in the country, and that paper supposes that the bill "will make labor scarcer and therefore raise wages."

Apparently that is what congress wants. The house passed the Burnett bill, in spite of the fact that literacy test bills have been vetoed by three different presidents, by a vote of 308 to 87, which some take to mean that the bill will be passed over the presidential veto, if Mr. Wilson should care to exercise that right as he once did. The passage of the Burnett bill in the senate is predicted, and current events seem to indicate the truth of the prediction.

The questions raised by the bill have to do almost altogether with labor matters, because all exceptional immigration is provided for. The subject to be considered is whether or not the United States can better bear the importation of more labor than it can bear the increase of the wages of the labor already within the gates. According to the enemies of the bill its passage means "scarcer labor and better wages," which might be taken as one hundred points in its favor rather than a single point against it.

The president of the American Federation of Labor, Samuel Gompers, approves of the bill. He says that there is very little opportunity in the United States for additional imported labor. Labor has been brought to this country for the purpose of exploitation, says the great labor leader, and until labor develops for itself powers of resistance and determination to secure things for itself it has little opportunity here. President Gompers says the section of the Burnett bill providing a literacy test provides no unfair requirements. The literacy test section excludes "all aliens over sixteen years of age, who cannot read the English language, or some other language or dialect, including Hebrew or Yiddish; provided, that any admissible alien, or any alien heretofore or hereafter legally admitted, or any citizen of the United States, may bring in or send for his father or grandfather over fifty-five years of age, his wife, his mother, his grandmother, or his unmarried or widowed daughter, if otherwise admissible, whether such relative can read or not, and such relative shall be permitted to enter."

The literacy test will not close the sheltering gates of this nation to those religiously persecuted, as exceptions are made in the bill to provide for such cases, and no other policy is radically changed by the bill. Therefore, it is clearly apparent why the house and senate favor the Burnett bill, and the opposition of some sources is not so easily accounted for.

IT IS INSANITY

German minds are mighty serious in their consideration of the latest development in the affairs between that nation and the United States, as uttered by President Wilson in his recent ultimatum on submarine warfare. Now that the president has despatched the demands of a nation that is solidly behind him in his action, our fond hopes of peaceful conclusions seem to go glimmering in a cloud of severed diplomatic relations. The situation is most critical, since the United States has turned the other cheek to the insulting slaps of her enemies for the last time, and the nation must get behind its chief with the loyalty of the brotherhood of freedom expressing itself more strongly than ever before.

The voice of the German people is

heard in what is probably its truest tones through Admiral von Holtzendorff, chief of the admiralty staff, who says: "We have no desire for a break with the United States. That would be insanity. We shall not bring it about despite our desire to push vigorously our submarine warfare." Insanity, indeed. And if the German people acquiesce to the display of that particular form of insanity just what is it that is to befall us?

It is not to be presumed, until her reply to the president's ultimatum is received, that Germany will give ground as a result of that great document. Germany is not fighting a war of that kind, and it is not beyond the ordinary imagination to picture that nation and the United States at sword's points if the present diplomatic point fails to win. The American people are not prepared to join themselves to the allied forces against Germany and have no ambition to do so, yet to avoid the break in relationship with that power seems impossible. The president took the only open course and if the result should be as disastrous as has been predicted the blame will be with the government of Germany and not with the United States.

It is not to be doubted that there would be some noticeable effect upon Germany should the diplomatic break become the terrible fact that its shadow presages. There are several small powers, tottering to this side and that in their support, which would be greatly influenced by any action taken by the United States. Although, as a whole, the support of these powers would be small, they are valuable allies to the Imperial forces and Germany is watching her step carefully to avoid anything that would swerve these helpers toward her enemies. There is hope for lasting peace and deliverance from the devastating terrors of the great war in the farsightedness of the German rule. If Germany does appreciate the influence any action by the United States would have on these powers, and acts according to the dictates of the common sense that sees the danger, then we shall continue, on a more harmonious ground than ever, to enjoy friendly relations with the kaiser's great family.

THE BARD OF AVON

Someone is everlastingly sticking his finger into the pie of the world's fondest traditions and most sacred history, disregarding recorded facts and disrupting thought. The latest malefactor is an Illinois circuit judge, who declares, in a decision handed down in his court, that William Shakespeare was not the author of the famous works attributed to him, but that Lord Bacon was guilty of those noble literary gems.

It seems odd that one in Judge Tutthill's position should attempt to contradict the knowledge of research that has lasted over a period of nearly three hundred years, since the death of Shakespeare, and should attempt to deny the wisdom of the foremost men and women, and the majority, in the literary world. It seems that Judge Tutthill's decision is an arbitrary one and entirely uncalled for. That it will have little effect on the literary world is evident from the instant uproar that was heard throughout the United States when the findings of the court were made known. The United States is the only part of the world concerned in Judge Tutthill's discovery. England and Europe generally will not be interested, for they are steeped in the love of William Shakespeare, and all the rulings of modern circuit courts cannot transfer that love even to so great a man as was Lord Bacon.

The Baconian theory has been given great study for many years, but the majority of thinkers on the subject were about to give up as hopeless the task of glorifying Bacon for the work of Shakespeare until Judge Tutthill came to the rescue, and as a result they will probably more willingly

give up than they would have otherwise. If Judge Tutthill has reasonable assurance that Bacon was the author of the library attributed to the Bard of Avon he may rest content with the knowledge, for the remainder of the world is loath to accept it.

On the surface it appears that the jurist's decision is as arbitrary as is the statement of a well-known woman nearer home, who set her own mind at ease in the matter of the Baconian theory by saying that Lord Bacon could not have written the love scenes that are contained in the works of Shakespeare. Hundreds of years after the mistaken circuit judge has passed to his pleasant reward, and as many years after the Baconian theories have been hurled into oblivion, the world will read, with the same delight as it does today, the immortal dramas of William Shakespeare.

NEVER AGAIN

A frequently repeated prediction is that the "wets" are doomed to everlasting oblivion, and in the light of the accomplishments of prohibition in this state the prediction will undeniably hold good. There are few to say that the few evil effects of prohibition are not rapidly being overcome. There are fewer who will say that Oregon is not a better state without the saloon, and there are none who will not live to see the day that this and other states will be genuine in their thanksgiving for freedom from the terrors of liquor.

Oregon has benefited immeasurably, and will continue to benefit as it relaxes from the sudden relief from the saloon evil. In the light of these facts it is interesting to note that

MORE ON GOOD ROADS

A map that came into the Courier's office recently shows, in large red lines, a veritable net of improved highways from edge to edge of the United States, roads which have been built up practically entirely within the past five or ten years. There seems to be no section of the nation that is not touched by one of these red road lines. But—there is another chapter to the story. All the red lines do not indicate a road developed to the highest state. In fact very few of them mean that much. There are a few of the roads indicated on the map in question that are wonderful products of the road building business. There are others that are only tolerably good roads. As the good roads campaign goes on the improvement of many miles of highway is accomplished each year, and the network is constantly becoming more nearly a reality. Every state government, the federal government, counties and cities, have added their efforts to the good roads campaign within the past few years. The result has been a wonderful increase in road building.

In spite of this there are several million miles of very bad roads in the United States. Bad roads not only spell decreased profit for the farmer, because of the difficulty of transportation; they not only mean mud and slush, but they mean pestilence, poverty, privation and ignorance. The statement is borne out without question by frequent example. Where has a road been built in the past decade, a road that is worthy the name, where the general tone of the district through which it passes has not been greatly improved? It is apparent no sooner than the road is completed,

bearded growth of grass might be hewn down, thus making the yard a hundred times more slightly. It is high time that the spade and the rake were being brought into play, and those who have the proper degree of civic pride will not delay to grasp the opportunity to make their own homes more attractive and to make Oregon City more nearly the garden spot that those whose hearts are in the city wish it to be.

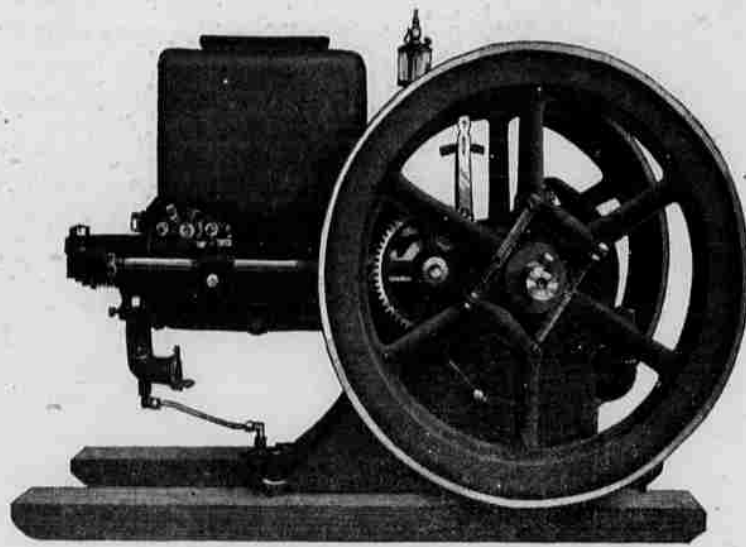
MASS WOULD QUIT

Committee Chairman Alleges Stress of Business in Resigning

Giving as his reason for the action the stress of private business, Ernest T. Mass, chairman of the Democratic County Central committee, and former sheriff of Clackamas county, last week presented his resignation as chairman of the committee. "Having gone into the hotel business," says Mr. Mass, "and feeling that I cannot, therefore, devote the time to the office of chairman of the Democratic County Central committee that should be devoted to it, I have taken this as the proper time to present my resignation."

Mr. Mass named no particular time at which he desired to be relieved from the office, but suggested in his communication to B. J. Staats, secretary of the central committee, that a meeting be called at once to consider the resignation and the election of his successor. Who this will be, of course, is problematical, as there are several prominent party workers in the county who are considered the proper timber to relieve Mr. Mass if his resignation should be accepted.

Secretary Staats is arranging the details of a meeting which will be



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Russia is in strong and harmoniously on the chorus, "Never Again" after fourteen months without vodka. It is interesting to note, from official Russian statistics, that wages have increased in some districts in that country as much as 500 per cent, since vodka was banished. Imprisonment has decreased 72 per cent., and savings deposits have increased 8 per cent. Crime of all kinds has decreased 62 per cent.; the suicide rate has fallen off greatly and hospitals formerly filled to overflowing are now only partly filled. The efficiency of factory workmen has increased in Russia as much as 15 per cent., and absenteeism in factories has fallen 60 per cent.

How truly do good things effect their goodness in all parts of the world. Statistics here in Oregon would reveal much the same figures as those that come to us from Russia. Here workmen are saving the money once turned into the saloon treasury. They are paying the bills with the money they once spent for liquor. They and their families are wearing better clothes and the working population has increased greatly. Prohibition has come to stay, for the far reaching benefit it has brought to Oregon it has brought to the people of other states and other countries, and the appreciation of these people will never allow liquor to usurp again the place it held for so long in the world's scheme of existence.

that the schools become better, the farms take on a more prosperous air, the children seem brighter, (whether they are or not,) community pride is aroused, and life becomes better in every way. It is a fact. Clackamas county has done well, and will, as time goes on, steadily improve, and there is hardly anyone here who would dare contradict, in the face of the facts that are here for them to see, that good roads are an investment whose value can be computed in plain figures.

A CITY BEAUTIFUL

Now that the housewife's fancy has successfully turned to thoughts of spring housecleaning, and the manifold tasks of that annual tussle with dust and dirt has been added to the accomplishments of the year, the subject of the spring clean-up, with reference to the out-of-doors, comes to mind. These pretty days, when the sun is creeping out in warmer radiance each day, the out-of-doors seems to be the most important part of the home place, but, sadly, it is often the most neglected.

In launching the clean-up campaign the plea this year is a rehearsal of the same old story, but the cause is as worthy as it ever has been. About every home there is some work that could be done this spring that would make the home a better place to live in. The house might be painted, the shrubs and trees might be cared for, weeds might be cut; yes, even the

LARGER CHEESE FACTORY

The farmers of the Canby community are having great success with the cheese factory which went into operation there early in the year. The business of the institution has been growing steadily and only last week it was necessary to install a new vat to provide sufficient equipment to take

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care of the increased supply of milk that is being brought in. The addition of this vat doubles the capacity of the plant. It is estimated that the daily output of the new factory is valued at \$125, which means more than \$3,000 a month.

A good market is found for the entire product, according to the management, and the sales field of the company is rapidly extending from end to end of the Pacific coast. The management of the cheese factory has under consideration a plan whereby it will be possible to guarantee to farmers monthly or semi-monthly payment for the milk they bring in.

FLEGEL TALKS ON HYGIENE

Gladstone Auditorium Holds Large Audience at Timely Meet

A. F. Flegel of Portland was a principal speaker at the social hygiene meeting at Gladstone on Friday evening, when a large audience gathered to hear addresses by a number of prominent social workers. Mr. Flegel kept his audience interested by the good sense of his remarks, and he strongly praised the work of the social hygiene societies of the state. Dr. W. E. Hempstead and H. E. Cross spoke at the same meeting.

A large audience of women were interested listeners in the afternoon to the addresses of Mrs. G. N. Woolley and Dr. Emma Wickström of Portland.

H. E. Cross, H. O. Paddock, Rev. R. L. Dunn, Rev. Thomas Broomfield and Dr. W. E. Hempstead were appointed members of a committee to represent Gladstone and were instructed to keep in touch with the Oregon Social Hygiene society and the work that organization is doing in the state.

Mr. Hawley Entertained

The banquet given on Thursday evening by Cataract Hose company of the city fire department in honor of W. P. Hawley, Sr., was decidedly successful and the guests greatly enjoyed the entertainment that was provided by a committee in charge of the

affair. About fifty were present to participate in the pleasure of the evening, in addition to Beach's Boys' band, which acquitted itself delightfully. Among the speakers called upon by Judge Grant B. Dimick as toastmaster, were W. P. Hawley, Sr., former Mayor L. E. Jones, George Pusey, Harry Bradley, Charles Croner and J. E. Frost. The committee which had charge of arrangements for the evening's entertainment comprised D. E. Frost, chairman; Harry Freeman, William Curtis and J. Nelson.



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(Paid Adv. by O. W. Eastham.)

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